

module-14-magic-squares - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - primary band

Module 14 — Magic Squares — Bhadragaṇita (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Bhadragaṇita* · **Band:** Primary (3-5) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita's 1356 CE magic-square algorithms.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 14's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Show a 3×3 grid with numbers 1-9. “All rows, all columns, both diagonals add to 15! Magic!”

Core idea · 15 min

A magic square: numbers in a grid where rows, columns, diagonals all add to the same.

The 3×3 with 1-9:

2	7	6
9	5	1
4	3	8

All rows = 15. All columns = 15. Diagonals too!

The middle number is ALWAYS 5. (Try shifting numbers around.)

Demonstration · 10 min

Show the 3 × 3 magic square. Children find the rows that add to 15, the columns, the diagonals. Cheer for each find.

Source moment · 5 min

Tell the story of Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita, who in 1356 wrote a book full of number puzzles, called *Gaṇita-kaumudī* — “Moonlight of Numbers.”

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Decorate the 3×3 magic square. Each child draws the square with colours, frames, and animals around the numbers.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

Each child shows their decorated 3×3 . Cheer.

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Discover the 3×3
- **Day 02** — Magic constant
- **Day 03** — How many 3×3 magic squares?
- **Day 04** — Stair-step method
- **Day 05** — Practice — 5×5 and 7×7
- **Day 06** — 4×4 and the Khajuraho square
- **Day 07** — Historical context — Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita
- **Day 08** — Cross-cultural — Lo Shu, Dürer, Indian
- **Day 09** — Design your own magic square
- **Day 10** — Final share + assessment

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.